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Methods providing encoding and/or decoding of video using a syntax indicator and picture header

Abstract

There are provided mechanisms for processing encoded image data. The method comprises receiving an encoded bitstream comprising parameter set information. The parameter set information may comprise a syntax indicator, a first coded portion comprising first coded sample information for a picture and a second coded portion comprising second coded sample information for the picture. The method further comprises, responsive to a first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element from a picture header of the encoded bitstream. The method further comprises, responsive to the first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the picture header of the encoded bitstream.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This [.application is.]. .Iadd.patent application is for a broadening reissue of U.S. Pat. No. 11,677,957. U.S. Pat. No. 11,677,957 is also the subject of broadening reissue application Ser. No. 19/234,526, filed on Jun. 11, 2025, which is a continuation reissue application of this patent application. U.S. Pat. No. 11,677,957 issued Jun. 13, 2023 from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/739,256 which was filed May 9, 2022 as .Iaddend.a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/640,908, filed on Feb. 21, 2020, .Iadd.now U.S. Pat. No. 11,356,667, issued Jun. 7, 2022, .Iaddend.which itself is a 35 U.S.C. § 371 national stage application of PCT International Application No. PCT/SE2019/051260, filed on Dec. 10, 2019, which in turns claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/782,998, filed on Dec. 20, 2018, the disclosures and content of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to video processing, and more particularly, video encoding and/or decoding and related methods and devices.

(2) High Efficiency Video Coding ("HEVC") is a block-based video codec standardized by ITU-T and MPEG that uses both temporal and spatial prediction. Spatial prediction can be achieved using intra ("I") prediction from within the current picture. Temporal prediction can be achieved using uni-directional ("P") or bi-directional inter ("B") prediction on a block level from previously decoded reference pictures. A difference between original pixel data and predicted pixel data can be referred to as a residual. In an encoder, the residual can be transformed into the frequency domain, quantized, and then entropy coded before being transmitted together with prediction parameters such as prediction mode and motion vectors. The prediction parameters may also be entropy coded.

By quantizing the transformed residuals, a tradeoff between bitrate and quality of the video may be controlled. The decoder can perform entropy decoding, inverse quantization, and inverse transformation to obtain the residual. The decoder can add the residual to an intra or inter prediction to reconstruct a picture.

(3) MPEG and ITU-T are working on a successor to HEVC called Versatile Video Coding (“VVC”). Both HEVC and VVC define a Network Abstraction Layer (“NAL”). Data (e.g., both video and non-video data of HEVC and VVC) is encapsulated in NAL units. The NAL unit begins with a NAL unit header, which among other things comprises the NAL unit type that identifies what type of data is carried in the NAL unit. The NAL unit type is transmitted in the `nal_unit_type` codeword in the NAL unit header and the type indicates and defines how the NAL unit should be parsed and decoded. A bitstream consists of a series of concatenated NAL units. An example of the syntax for the HEVC NAL unit is shown in FIG. 6 and an example of the syntax for the NAL unit header is shown in FIG. 7.

(4) For single layer coding in HEVC, an access unit (“AU”) is the coded representation of a picture, which may consist of several video coding layer (“VCL”) NAL units as well as non-VCL NAL units. A coded video sequence (“CVS”) in HEVC is a series of access units starting at an intra random access point (“IRAP”) access unit up to, but not comprising the next IRAP access unit in decoding order. The decoding order is the order in which NAL units may be decoded, which is the same as the order of the NAL units within the bitstream. The decoding order may be different from the output order, which is the order in which decoded pictures are to be output, such as for display, by the decoder.

(5) Non-VCL NAL units are NAL units that do not carry coded sample values directly, such as for example parameter sets. Both VVC and HEVC define picture parameter set (“PPS”) and sequence parameter set (“SPS”), which comprise parameters valid for a picture or a sequence respectively. In HEVC there is another parameter set, video parameter set (“VPS”), that comprises information valid for several layers. A new VPS can be activated at the start of a new CVS. When VVC is finalized it may or may not comprise a VPS or similar.

(6) The first byte of each NAL unit in VVC and HEVC contains the `nal_unit_type` syntax element. A decoder or bitstream parser can conclude how the NAL unit should be handled, e.g. parsed and decoded, after looking at the first byte.

(7) The VVC video coding standard may use a block structure referred to as quadtree plus binary tree plus ternary tree block structure (“QTBT+TT”) where each picture is first partitioned into square blocks called coding tree units (“CTUs”). The size of all CTUs are identical and the partition is done without any syntax controlling it. Each CTU is further partitioned into coding units (“CUs”) that can have either square or rectangular shapes. The CTU is first partitioned by a quad tree structure, then it may be further partitioned with equally sized partitions either vertically or horizontally in a binary structure to form coding units (“CUs”). A block can have either a square or rectangular shape. The depth of the quad tree and binary tree can be set by the encoder in the bitstream. An example of dividing a CTU using QTBT is illustrated in FIGS. 1A-B. The ternary tree (“TT”) part adds the possibility to divide a CU into three partitions instead of two equally sized partitions; this increases the possibilities to use a block structure that better fits the content structure in a picture.

(8) The concept of slices in HEVC divides the picture into independently coded slices, where each slice is read in raster scan order in units of CTUs. Different coding types could be used for slices of the same picture, i.e. a slice could either be an I-slice, P-slice or B-slice. Slices can enable resynchronization in case of data loss.

(9) VVC may not use traditional slices as in HEVC. Instead tiles may play a larger role in VVC due to increased demand for spatial random access from video services comprising VR streaming.

(10) The VVC video coding standard may comprise a tool called tiles that divides a picture into rectangular spatially independent regions. Tiles in the draft VVC coding standard are very similar

to the tiles used in HEVC. Using tiles, a picture in VVC can be partitioned into rows and columns of samples where a tile is an intersection of a row and a column. FIG. 2 shows an example of a tile partitioning using 4 tile rows and 5 tile columns resulting in a total of 20 tiles for the picture.

(11) The tile structure can be signaled in the picture parameter set (“PPS”) by specifying the thicknesses of the rows and the widths of the columns. Individual rows and columns can have different sizes, but the partitioning may span across the entire picture, from left to right and top to bottom respectively.

(12) There is no decoding dependency between tiles of the same picture. This comprises intra prediction, context selection for entropy coding and motion vector prediction. One exception is that in-loop filtering dependencies may be allowed between tiles.

(13) The bits of a coded picture in VVC are partitioned into `tile_group_layer_rbsp( )` data chunks, where each such chunk is encapsulated into its own group NAL unit. The data chunk comprises a tile group header and tile group data, where the tile group data comprises an integer number of coded complete tiles. FIGS. 8-10 show the related draft VVC specification standard syntax. FIG. 8 shows a tile group layer RBSP in the draft VVC standard. FIG. 9 shows a tile group header in the draft VVC standard.

(14) The tile group header can start with a `tile_group_pic_parameter_set_id` syntax element. This element can specify the PPS that should be activated and used for decoding the tile group. The `tile_group_address` code word specifies the tile address of the first tile in the tile group. The next code word in the tile group header, `num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1`, can specify the number of tiles there are in the tile group.

(15) `tile_group_type` can specify the coding type of the tile group. It can specify what prediction types, intra prediction, uni-directional prediction, or bi-directional prediction are present in the tile group.

(16) `log_2_diff_ctu_max_bt_size` can specify the difference between the luma CTB size and the maximum luma size (width or height) of a coding block that can be split using a binary split.

(17) `sbtmvp_size_override_flag` can specify whether the syntax element `log_2_sbtmvp_active_size_minus2` is present for the current tile group.

(18) `log_2_sbtmvp_active_size_minus2` plus 2 can specify the value of the block size that is used for deriving the motion parameters for a particular motion compensation mode (temporal motion vector prediction) for the current tile group. When `log_2_sbtmvp_size_active_minus2` is not present, it can be inferred to be equal to a default value.

(19) `tile_group_temporal_mvp_enabled_flag` can specify whether temporal motion vector predictors can be used for inter prediction.

(20) `mvd_l1_zero_flag` equal to 1 can indicate that some delta motion vectors are always equal to zero.

(21) `collocated_from_l0_flag` can specify whether the collocated picture used for temporal motion vector prediction is derived from reference picture list 0 or reference picture list 1.

(22) `six_minus_max_num_merge_cand` can specify the maximum number of merging motion vector prediction (“MVP”) candidates supported in the tile group subtracted from 6.

(23) `dep_quant_enabled_flag` can specify whether the dependent quantization coding tool is enabled or disabled.

(24) `sign_data_hiding_enabled_flag` can specify whether the sign data hiding tool is enabled or disabled.

(25) If there are more than one tile in the tile group, the entry points of the tiles except the first one can be signaled. First there is a code word, `offset_len_minus1`, that specifies the number of bits used for signaling each of the offsets. Then there is a list of entry point offset code words; `entry_point_offset_minus1`. These specify byte offsets in the bitstream that can be used by a decoder to find the starting point of each tile in order to decode them in parallel. Without these offsets, a decoder would have to parse tile data in order to find out where each tile starts in the

bitstream. The first tile in the tile group immediately follows after the tile group header so there is no byte offset sent for that tile. This means that the number of offsets is one less than the number of tiles in the tile group.

(26) FIG. **10** shows tile group data in the draft VVC standard. The tile group data can comprise coded data for CTUs in the tile group. In this example, there is a for loop over all tiles in the tile group. Inside that for loop there is another for loop over all CTUs in the tile. The number of CTUs in different tiles may differ as the tile row heights and tile column widths may not be equal. For entropy coding reasons, there can be a bit set to one at the end of each tile. Each tile ends with a byte alignment which means that the data for each tile in the tile group starts on an even byte address in the bitstream. This can allow entry points to be specified in number of bytes. The tile group header also ends with a byte alignment.

(27) In some embodiments, the term segment can be used as a more general term than tiles, since the solutions in this application can be applied to different kinds of picture partitioning schemes and not only tile partitions known from HEVC and the VVC draft. A tile is one example of a segment, but other examples may exist.

(28) FIGS. **3A-C** show a picture **10** of a video stream and an exemplary partitioning of the picture into units **8**, segments **11** and segment groups **12**. FIG. **3A** shows a picture **10** that comprises 64 units **8**. FIG. **3B** shows the segment partition structure **13** of the same picture **10** comprising of 16 segments **11**. The partition structure **13** is shown by dashed lines. Each segment **11** comprises a number of units. A segment can either comprise an integer number of complete units or a combination of complete and partial units. A number of segments form a segment group. FIG. **3C** shows the segment group partitioning of the same picture **10** that comprises 8 segment groups. The segment group may comprise segments in raster scan order. Alternatively, the segment group may comprise any group of segments that together form a rectangle. Alternatively, the segment group may comprise any subset of segments.

(29) FIG. **4** shows a picture **10** where the dashed lines show a partition structure dividing the picture into four segments. FIG. **4** also shows three units **16**, **17**, **18**. As shown in the figure, two units **16**, **17** belong to one current segment **15** and one unit **18** belongs to a different, neighboring segment **14**. The segments are independent with respect to other segments which means that segment boundaries are handled similar to picture boundaries when decoding the units. This affects the derivation process of elements during decoding such as e.g. the derivation of intra prediction modes and the derivation of quantization parameter values.

(30) Intra modes can be used and signaled for units that only use prediction from previously decoded samples of the current picture for sample prediction. The derivation of the intra prediction mode in a current unit **16** depends on previously derived intra prediction modes in other, neighboring units **17**. With segments being independent, the derivation of the intra prediction mode in a current unit **16** may only depend on previously derived intra prediction modes in units **17** that belong to the current segment **15** and may not depend on any intra prediction mode in any unit **18** that belongs to a different segment **14**.

(31) The partition structure in FIG. **4** can make the intra prediction modes in units **18** in a different segment **14** unavailable for the derivation of the intra prediction mode for the units **16** in a current segment **15**. The mode in some units **18** in a different segment may have been used for derivation of an intra prediction mode in a unit **16** in a current segment **15** if those units would have belonged to the same segment. Instead, the segment boundary may have the same effect on intra mode derivation as a picture boundary for the units **16** in a current segment **15**.

(32) In some embodiments, a segment may be equivalent to a tile or slice. A segment group may be equivalent to a tile group. A segment header is the header of a segment or a segment group. A segment header may be equivalent to a tile group header or a slice header. In some embodiments, “tile” and “segment” can be used interchangeably. A unit may be equivalent to a CTU. In some embodiments, the terms “partition”, “structure” and “partition structure” can be used

interchangeably.

SUMMARY

(33) A first aspect of the embodiments defines a method for processing encoded image data. The method comprises receiving an encoded bitstream comprising parameter set information. The parameter set information may comprise a syntax indicator, a first coded portion comprising first coded sample information for a picture and a second coded portion comprising second coded sample information for the picture. The method further comprises, responsive to a first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element from a picture header of the encoded bitstream. The method further comprises, responsive to the first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the picture header of the encoded bitstream.

(34) A second aspect of the embodiments defines a method of generating encoded image data comprising generating the encoded bitstream according to the first aspect.

(35) A third aspect of the embodiments defines an electronic device comprising a processor and a memory coupled with the processor. The memory comprises instructions that, when executed by the processor, causes the electronic device to perform operations according to the first or the second aspect.

(36) A fourth aspect of the embodiments defines a computer program comprising program code to be executed by at least one processor of an electronic device, whereby execution of the program code causes the electronic device to perform a method according to the first or the second aspect.

(37) A fifth aspect of the embodiments defines a computer program product comprising a non-transitory storage medium comprising program code to be executed by at least one processor of an electronic device, whereby execution of the program code causes the electronic device to perform a method according to any of the first or the second aspect.

(38) According to some embodiments disclosed herein, a bitrate of encoded bitstreams for videos can be reduced while improving error resilience by using a syntax indicator and a picture header.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are comprised to provide a further understanding of the disclosure and are incorporated in and constitute a part of this application, illustrate certain non-limiting embodiments of inventive concepts. In the drawings:

(2) FIG. 1A-B are schematic diagrams illustrating examples of a partitioning of a CTU into CUs using QTBT;

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating an example of a tile partitioning of a picture;

(4) FIGS. 3A-C are schematic diagrams illustrating examples of partitions of a picture into segment groups, segments, and units;

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating an example of segments and intra prediction modes;

(6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an example of a bitstream with a picture header according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(7) FIG. 6 is a table illustrating an example of HEVC NAL unit syntax;

(8) FIG. 7 is a table illustrating an example of HEVC NAL unit header syntax;

(9) FIG. 8 is a table illustrating an example of a tile group layer RBSP in the draft VVC standard;

(10) FIG. 9 is a table illustrating an example of a tile group header in the draft VVC standard;

(11) FIG. 10 is a table illustrating an example of tile group data in the draft VVC standard;

(12) FIG. 11 is a table illustrating an example of NAL unit types according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(13) FIG. 12 is a table illustrating an example of picture header RBSP according to some

embodiments of inventive concepts;

(14) FIG. 13 is a table illustrating an example of sequence parameter set RBSP according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(15) FIG. 14 is a table illustrating an example of tile group header according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(16) FIG. 15 is a table illustrating an example of common header syntax according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(17) FIG. 16 is a table illustrating an example of byte alignment suppression according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(18) FIG. 17 is a block diagram of an example of an electronic device (UE) for encoding or decoding a bitstream with an optional picture header according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(19) FIG. 18 is a flow chart of an example of a process for decoding a bitstream with an optional picture header according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

(20) FIG. 19 is a flow chart of an example of a process for decoding a bitstream with an optional picture header according to some embodiments of inventive concepts;

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(21) Inventive concepts will now be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which examples of embodiments of inventive concepts are shown. Inventive concepts may, however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of present inventive concepts to those skilled in the art. It should also be noted that these embodiments are not mutually exclusive. Components from one embodiment may be tacitly assumed to be present/used in another embodiment.

(22) A problem with the use of segments may be that segment headers can contribute significantly to the bitrate of a video stream if the pictures are partitioned into many segments. It can be observed that the values of many segment header syntax elements are identical for all segments of the same picture. This means that the bitrate cost of segment headers can be reduced by signaling segment header information once or a few times per picture instead of repeating the same syntax elements for every segment. Some embodiments described herein comprise the APS proposed for HEVC and the header parameter set proposed in JVET-L0183 for VVC.

(23) A problem with the existing proposed solutions to reduce the segment header overhead is the error resilience properties of those solutions.

(24) In JVET-L0183 option 1, segment header syntax elements may optionally be moved to the PPS. This means that an encoder may send one picture parameter set per picture. If a PPS is lost due to packet losses, a decoder may not be able to detect the loss and the decoding may be erroneous. In some examples, a PPS is sent in the access unit of a picture and the PPS is lost. If there is another, previously sent PPS with the same PPS id, a decoder will decode the picture using that other PPS which may lead to erroneous decoding.

(25) In JVET-L0183 option 2, a header parameter set (“HPS”) is introduced where the HPS may or may not be sent in an AU. This may result in a lost HPS for which a decoder may not be able to detect the loss. In some examples, a HPS is sent in the access unit of a picture and the HPS is lost. If there is another, previously sent HPS with the same HPS id, a decoder will decode the picture using that other HPS which may lead to erroneous decoding.

(26) Various embodiments described herein may address this error resilience problem by introducing a sequence parameter set flag, `sps_picture_header_enabled_flag`, and a picture header. Some of the syntax elements that are currently in the segment header are moved to a separate syntax group `common_segment_header`(). If the flag `sps_picture_header_enabled_flag` is equal to 0, the `common_segment_header` group is present in each segment header meaning that traditional

segment headers are used. If the flag is equal to 1, there may be no common_segment_header group in any segment header. Instead, there may be a picture header present in each access unit that contains the common_segment_header().

(27) In some embodiments, the flag is renamed to sps_picture_header_repeated_flag. A picture header can be present in each access unit regardless of the value of the flag. If the flag is equal to 0, the common_segment_header group is present in the picture header only and not in the segment header. If the flag is equal to 1, the common_segment_header group is present in every segment header and not in any picture header. In additional or alternative embodiments, the common_segment_header group is also present in every picture header. According to some embodiments, error robustness may be preserved such that the decoder may be aware of any loss of information.

(28) If sps_picture_header_enabled_flag is equal to 0, the solution is identical to the current use of segment header which enables a decoder to be loss aware. If the flag is equal to 1, then any loss of a picture header is immediately detected since there may be one picture header present in each access unit.

(29) According to some other embodiments, any loss of picture header may be immediately detected since there may be one picture header present in each access unit.

(30) Some embodiments comprise a proposed picture header. The picture header can be a separate byte-aligned entity in the bitstream. In the HEVC or VVC video coding framework, the proposed picture header can be implemented as a separate NAL unit with its own NAL unit type. The proposed NAL unit type is PIC_NUT, as a name used in some embodiments.

(31) A parameter set flag can be used that specifies whether picture headers are used or not. The flag can be put in the sequence parameter set and can control the presence of picture headers in the entire CVS or in the entire bitstream. Additionally or alternatively, the flag may be put in a VPS or another parameter set.

(32) In some embodiments, syntax elements that are common for multiple segment headers in a picture can be put into a separate syntax table called common_tile_group_header() and can introduce the following rules on the presence and location of the picture header and that syntax table: (1) If the parameter set flag is equal to a first value, there may be no picture header anywhere in the CVS and all syntax elements in common_tile_group_header() may be comprised in every segment header in the CVS; (2) If the parameter set flag is equal to a second value, there may be exactly one picture header for each picture in the CVS. In other words, there may be exactly one picture header in every AU in the CVS. The picture header comprises all syntax elements in common_tile_group_header() and the syntax elements in common_tile_group_header() may not be present in any segment header in the CVS; and (3) If picture headers are present, the picture header may be located before any VCL NAL unit of the same access unit.

(33) In additional or alternative embodiments, the picture header and the access unit delimiter are merged, such that the syntax elements in common_tile_group_header() are present in the access unit delimiter when the parameter set flag is equal to a second value. An access unit delimiter is a NAL unit with its own NAL unit type that can be used to indicate the boundary between two access units. An access unit delimiter can be present in the bitstream as the very first NAL unit in an access unit, or alternatively as the very last NAL unit in an access unit, thereby providing the indication. In HEVC, the access unit delimiter payload may carry an indication of the type of slices present in the coded pictures in the access unit containing the access unit delimiter NAL unit and to simplify the detection of the boundary between access units. There is no normative decoding process associated with the access unit delimiter in HEVC.

(34) In this embodiment, if the access unit delimiter and the picture header is merged, there will be a joint NAL unit type carrying both types of data. This means that the picture header information is sent as the very first (or very last) NAL unit in the access units where it is present. A joint NAL unit type could go under the name Access unit delimiter NAL unit, picture header NAL unit, or any

other name.

(35) With a joint NAL unit type, assumed to be called access unit delimiter, the rules may look as follows: (1) If the parameter set flag is equal to a first value, there may be no picture header information present in any access unit NAL unit in the CVS and all syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header( )` may be comprised in every segment header in the CVS; (2) If the parameter set flag is equal to a second value, there may be exactly one access unit delimiter NAL unit for each picture in the CVS. In other words, there may be exactly one picture header in every AU in the CVS. The access unit delimiter NAL unit may comprise all syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header( )` and the syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header( )` may not be present in any segment header in the CVS; and (3) The access unit delimiter NAL unit may precede all other NAL units that belong to the same access unit. In other words, the access unit delimiter NAL unit may be the first NAL unit in its access unit if it is present.

(36) In some embodiments, picture headers are optional in the bitstream, but if they are present, they are present for all access units in the CVS. FIG. 5 shows a bitstream **30** and a corresponding decoded current picture **20**. The bitstream comprises a parameter set **1** and a coded picture comprising an optional picture header **16**, a coded first portion **14** and a coded second portion **15**. The coded first portion **14** is decoded into a decoded first portion of sample values **18** and the coded second portion is decoded into a decoded second portion of sample values **17**. The parameter set **1**, the picture header **16**, the coded first portion **14** and the coded second portion **15** may be packed in separate units. The units may be byte aligned and may be NAL units or similar.

(37) The first and second coded portions **14**, **15** are decoded by decoding the following five elements: 1) The parameter set information **1** can be a sequence parameter set that is used for decoding multiple pictures and not just one picture as in this example; 2) Header information **2** for the first portion; 3) Header information **3** for the second portion; 4) Coded sample information **4** for the first portion; and 5) Coded sample information **5** for the second portion.

(38) The coded sample information **4**, **5** may, for example, be the tile group data in the VVC draft.

(39) The parameter set information contains a parameter set syntax element **13**, that is indicative of at least a first and second value. It can be a one-bit flag in the SPS.

(40) The header information for the first portion **2** comprises a first group of syntax elements **6**, **12** and a second group of syntax elements **7** where the second group of syntax elements **7** and the coded sample information for the first portion **4** are located in the first coded portion **14**. The first group of syntax elements **6**, **12** may be located either in the header information for the first portion **2** or in a separate packet **16** as explained below.

(41) The header information for the second portion **3** comprises a third group of syntax elements **8**, **12** and a fourth group of syntax elements **9** where the fourth group of syntax elements **9** and the coded sample information for the second portion **5** are located in the second coded portion **15**. The third group of syntax elements **8**, **12** may be located either in the header information for the second portion **3** or in a separate packet **16** as explained below.

(42) Now, if the syntax element **13** is of a first value, the first group of syntax elements **6** is present and located in the first coded portion **14** and the third group of syntax elements **8** is present and located in a second coded portion **15**. The decoding of the first coded portion **14** is done by using syntax element values from the first **6** and second **7** group and the decoding of the second portion **15** is done by using syntax element values from the third **8** and fourth **9** group. The presence of the separate packet **16** is dependent on the syntax element **13** and if the syntax element **13** is of a first value, the separate packet **16** is not present in the bitstream.

(43) But if the syntax element **13** is of a second value, the first group **6** and the third group **8** of syntax elements are not present in the first coded portion **14** and second coded portion **15**. Instead, a single group **12** located in a separate packet **16** is present. The separate packet **16** precedes any packets carrying sample information for the picture. It therefore precedes the first **14** and second **15** coded portions. The separate packet **16** is positioned after any packets carrying sample information

for any previous picture in decoding order. The separate packet **16** can be comprised in the access unit that contains the current picture as a NAL unit and the NAL unit precedes any VCL NAL unit in the access unit. The decoding of the first coded portion **14** is done by using syntax element values from the single **12** and second **7** group and the decoding of the second coded portion **15** is done by using syntax element values from the single **12** and fourth **9** group.

(44) In some embodiments, any syntax element that is present in any of the single **12**, first **6** and third **8** group is also present in all three groups **12,6,8**. This can be implemented as a joint syntax structure that is parsed either from the separate packet **16** or from the header information **2, 3** depending on the value of the syntax element **13**. Likewise, any syntax element present in any of the second **7** and fourth **9** group is also present in the other group. On top of the draft VVC specification, this embodiment may look as depicted in FIGS. **11-14**. FIG. **11** shows NAL unit types, FIG. **12** shows a picture header RBSP, FIG. **13** shows a sequence parameter set RBSP, and FIG. **14** shows a tile group header. FIG. **12** shows a picture header RBSP.

(45) sps_picture_header_enabled_flag equal to 1 specifies that one picture header NAL unit may be present in all access units in the CVS. sps_picture_header_enabled_flag equal to 0 specifies that there may be no picture header NAL units in the CVS.

(46) FIG. **14** shows a tile group header. The semantics of all syntax elements in tile_group_header is identical to the latest VVC draft:

(47) tile_group_pic_parameter_set_id specifies the value of pps_pic_parameter_set_id for the PPS in use. The value of tile_group_pic_parameter_set_id may be in the range of 0 to 63, inclusive.

(48) tile_group_address specifies the tile address of the first tile in the tile group. The length of tile_group_address is Ceil(Log 2 (NumTilesInPic)) bits. The value of tile_group_address may be in the range of 0 to NumTilesInPic-1, inclusive, and the value of tile_group_address may not be equal to the value of tile_group_address of any other coded tile group NAL unit of the same coded picture. When tile_group_address is not present it is inferred to be equal to 0.

(49) num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1 plus 1 specifies the number of tiles in the tile group. The value of num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1 may be in the range of 0 to NumTilesInPic-1, inclusive. When not present, the value of num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1 is inferred to be equal to 0.

(50) offset_len_minus1 plus 1 specifies the length, in bits, of the entry_point_offset_minus1[i] syntax elements. The value of offset_len_minus1 may be in the range of 0 to 31, inclusive.

(51) entry_point_offset_minus1[i] plus 1 specifies the i-th entry point offset in bytes, and is represented by offset_len_minus1 plus 1 bits. The tile group data that follow the tile group header consists of num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1+1 subsets, with subset index values ranging from 0 to num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1, inclusive. The first byte of the tile group data is considered byte **0**. When present, emulation prevention bytes that appear in the tile group data portion of the coded tile group NAL unit are counted as part of the tile group data for purposes of subset identification. Subset **0** consists of bytes **0** to

(52) entry_point_offset_minus1[0], inclusive, of the coded tile group data, subset k, with k in the range of 1 to num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1-1, inclusive, consists of bytes firstByte[k] to lastByte[k], inclusive, of the coded tile group data with firstByte[k] and lastByte[k] defined as:

$$(53) \quad 1.\text{firstByte}[k] = \sum_{n=1}^k \text{Math.}(\text{entry_point_offset_minus}[n-1] + 1) \quad (737)$$

$$2.\text{lastByte}[k] = \text{firstByte}[k] + \text{entry_point_offset_minus}[k] \quad (738)$$

(54) The last subset (with subset index equal to num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1) consists of the remaining bytes of the coded tile group data.

(55) Each subset may consist of all coded bits of all CTUs in the tile group that are within the same tile.

(56) FIG. **15** shows a common header syntax. The semantics of all syntax elements in common_tile_group_header() is identical to the syntax elements in tile_group_header() in the

latest VVC draft. A decoder may perform all or a subset of the following steps for decoding a video coding layer NAL unit using this embodiment:

(57) 1. The decoder decodes a flag from a parameter set that specifies whether picture headers are used or not. The flag can be located in a sequence parameter set.

(58) 2. The decoder activates the parameter set by decoding one or more syntax elements from the bitstream that indicates activation of the parameter set.

(59) 3. If the flag was decoded to a first value, the decoder deduces that there may be no picture headers in the coded video bitstream. The decoder decodes a set of syntax elements S from a VCL NAL unit of a coded picture in the coded video bitstream and uses the decoded values of the set S when decoding the VCL NAL unit.

(60) 4. If the decoder detects the presence of a picture header in the coded video sequence when the value of the flag comprised in an active parameter set is equal to a first value, the decoder concludes that the bitstream is not compliant with codec specification and may interpret that as a bit-error, loss of data or non-compliant bitstream or encoder. It may report the error, perform error concealment or take other actions based on the knowledge that the bitstream is not compliant.

(61) 5. If the flag was decoded to a second value, the decoder deduces that there may be a picture header present in every access unit in the coded video bitstream. The decoder decodes a set of syntax elements T from a picture header for a picture of an access unit and uses the decoded values of the set T when decoding a VCL NAL unit of that access unit, where the set T contains the same syntax elements as the set S.

(62) 6. If the decoder detects that there is no picture header present for an access unit when the value of the flag comprised in an active parameter set is equal to a second value, the decoder concludes that the bitstream is not compliant with codec specification and may interpret that as a bit-error, loss of data or non-compliant bitstream or encoder. It may report the error, perform error concealment or take other actions based on the knowledge that the bitstream is not compliant.

(63) The picture header in the steps above may be carried in a NAL unit having a specific NAL unit type that indicates that the NAL unit contains picture header syntax elements.

(64) In some embodiments, there may be a mandatory picture header present in each access unit of the bitstream. The picture header may be located before any VCL NAL unit in the access unit. The picture header can be a separate byte-aligned entity in the bitstream. In the HEVC or VVC video coding framework, the proposed picture header is implemented as a separate NAL unit with its own NAL unit type. The proposed NAL unit type is PIC_NUT, but that is just a name used to describe this embodiment.

(65) Some embodiments can also comprise putting syntax elements that are common for multiple segment headers in a picture into a separate syntax table called `common_tile_group_header()` and to introduce the following rules on the presence and location of that syntax table:

(66) 1 If a parameter set flag is equal to a first value, all syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header()` may be comprised in every segment header in the CVS and there may be no syntax element in `common_tile_group_header()` present in any picture header in the CVS

(67) 2 If the parameter set flag is equal to a second value, all syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header()` may be comprised in every picture header in the CVS and there may be no syntax element in `common_tile_group_header()` present in any segment header in the CVS

(68) There may be syntax elements in the picture header that are present there regardless of where the syntax elements of `common_tile_group_header()` is located. One non-limiting example is `pic_parameter_set_id`.

(69) There may be syntax elements in the segment header that are present there regardless of where the syntax elements of `common_tile_group_header()` is located. One non-limiting example is tile group address or slice address related syntax elements. Another non-limiting example is entry point offset related syntax elements.

(70) In one variant of the proposed solution, the picture header and the access unit delimiter are merged, such that the syntax elements in `common_tile_group_header()` are present in the access unit delimiter when the parameter set flag is equal to a second value.

(71) The flag above can be put in the sequence parameter set and that it controls the location of `common_tile_group_header()` in the entire coded video sequence (CVS) or in the entire bitstream. In alternative solutions of this invention the flag may instead be put in a VPS or another parameter set.

(72) Some embodiments can be used together with any of the previous embodiments in this description.

(73) In some embodiments, the `common_tile_group_header()` syntax elements are split into multiple syntax element groups. For each group it is indicated where the syntax elements in that group is located, either in the segment header or in the picture header.

(74) In some embodiments, no code words are sent in the tile group header or slice header if the flag indicates that the syntax element group or all syntax element groups are located in the picture header and there is only one tile in the tile group header or slice header.

(75) This is shown in the proposed tile group header syntax below, where the presence of the picture parameter set ID is conditioned on the parameter set flag. If there is only one tile in the tile group or slice, the variable `NumTilesInPic` is set to 1 and therefore the `tile_group_address` syntax element is not present in the tile group header but inferred to be equal to 0. Likewise, the `num_tiles_in_tile_group_minus1` syntax element is not present either but is inferred to be equal to 0. Therefore, no `offset_len_minus1` nor `entry_point_offset_minus1` syntax elements are present.

(76) Bits for performing byte alignment are not present since with an empty `tile_group_header()` syntax structure, the `tile_group_header()` is byte aligned in the sense that the very next bit after the syntax structure will be positioned at a byte-aligned bit position. FIG. 16 is a table illustrating an example of byte alignment suppression.

(77) In some embodiments, a method is disclosed for decoding a picture 20 from a bitstream 30, the method comprising decoding a coded first portion 14 and a coded second portion 15 of the picture into a decoded first portion 16 and a decoded second portion 17 of sample values. The method can comprise decoding a coded first portion 14 and a coded second portion 15 of a coded picture by decoding the following five elements: parameter set information 1, header information for the first portion 2, header information for the second portion 3, coded sample information for the first portion 4 and coded sample information for the second portion 5. The parameter set information 1 contains a parameter set syntax element 13 indicative of at least a first value and a second value. The header information for the first portion 2 consists of a first group 6 of syntax elements and a second group 7 of syntax elements where the second group of syntax elements 7 and the coded sample information for the first portion 4 are located in the first portion 14. The header information for the second portion 3 consists of a third group 8 of syntax elements and a fourth group 9 of syntax elements where the fourth group of syntax elements 9 and the coded sample information for the second portion 5 are located in the second portion 15. If the syntax element 13 is of a first value, the location of the first group 6 of syntax element is located in the first portion 14 and the location of the third group 8 of syntax elements is located in a second portion 15, and the decoding of the first portion 14 is done by using syntax element values from the first 6 and second 7 group and the decoding of the second portion 15 is done by using syntax element values from the third 8 and fourth 9 group. If the syntax element 13 is of a second value, the first group 6 and the third group 8 are not present in the first 14 and second 15 portion. Instead, a single group 12 is located in a separate 16 packet ordered before any packets carrying sample information for the picture, comprising before the first and second portions, but after any packets carrying sample information for any previous picture in decoding order, and the decoding of the first portion 14 is done by using syntax element values from the single 12 and second 7 group and the decoding of the second portion 15 is done by using syntax element values from the single 12

and fourth **9** group. Any syntax element present in any of the single, first and third group is also present in any of the single, first and third group, and any syntax element present in any of the second and fourth group is also present in any of the second and fourth group.

(78) FIG. **17** is a block diagram illustrating an electronic device **1700** (which may be a wireless device, a 3GPP user equipment or UE device, etc.) according to some embodiments disclosed herein. As shown, electronic device **1700** may comprise processor **1703** coupled with communication interface **1701**, memory **1705**, camera **1707**, and screen **1709**. Communication interface **1701** may comprise one or more of a wired network interface (e.g., an Ethernet interface), a WiFi interface, a cellular radio access network (RAN) interface (also referred to as a RAN transceiver), and/or other wired/wireless network communication interfaces. Electronic device **1700** can thus provide wired/wireless communication over one or more wire/radio links with a remote storage system to transmit and/or receive an encoded video sequence. Processor **1703** (also referred to as a processor circuit or processing circuitry) may comprise one or more data processing circuits, such as a general purpose and/or special purpose processor (e.g., microprocessor and/or digital signal processor). Processor **1703** may be configured to execute computer program instructions from functional modules in memory **1705** (also referred to as a memory circuit or memory circuitry), described below as a computer readable medium, to perform some or all of the operations and methods that are described herein for one or more of the embodiments. Moreover, processor **1703** may be defined to comprise memory so that separate memory **1705** may not be required. Electronic device **1700** comprising, communication interface **1701**, processor **1703**, and/or camera **1707** may thus perform operations, for example, discussed below.

(79) According to some embodiments, electronic device **1700** (e.g., a smartphone) may generate an encoded video sequence that is either stored in memory **1705** and/or transmitted through communication interface **1701** over a wired network and/or wireless network to a remote device. In such embodiments, processor **1703** may receive a video sequence from camera **1709**, and processor may encode the video sequence to provide the encoded video sequence that may be stored in memory **1705** and/or transmitted through communication interface **1701** to a remote device.

(80) According to some other embodiments, electronic device **1700** may decode an encoded video sequence to provide a decoded video sequence that is rendered on display **1709** for a user to view. The encoded video sequence may be received from a remote communication device through communication interface **1701** and stored in memory **1705** before decoding and rendering by processor **1703**, or the encoded video sequence may be generated by processor **1703** responsive to a video sequence received from camera **1707** and stored in memory **1705** before decoding and rendering by processor **1703**. Accordingly, the same device may thus encode a video sequence and then decode the video sequence. Operations of encoding and decoding performed by processor **1703** will now be discussed with reference to FIGS. **18-19**.

(81) Operations of electronic device **1700** will now be discussed with reference to the flow chart of FIG. **18** according to some embodiments of inventive concepts. For example, modules (also referred to as units) may be stored in memory **1705** of FIG. **17**, and these modules may provide instructions so that when the instructions of a module are executed by processor **1703**, processor **1703** performs respective operations of the flow chart of FIG. **18**.

(82) According to some embodiments of inventive concepts, electronic device **1700** may decode an encoded bitstream corresponding to a plurality of pictures. The encoded bitstream can comprise a parameter set, an optional picture header, a first coded portion comprising first coded sample information for a picture, and a second coded portion comprising second coded sample information for the picture. At block **1810**, processor **1703** may obtain the encoded bitstream, for example, by receiving the encoded bitstream from a remote source over a network through communication interface **1701** and/or by retrieving the encoded bitstream from memory **1705**. According to some embodiments, processor **1703** may first receive the encoded bitstream and then save the encoded

video sequence to memory **1705** for later retrieval from memory.

(83) The encoded bitstream may comprise a parameter set with a syntax indicator or a syntax indicator. At block **1820**, processor **1703** may, in response to the value of the syntax indicator, decode the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element. At block **1830**, processor **1703** may, in response to the value of the syntax indicator, decode the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element.

(84) Various operations of FIG. **18** may be optional with respect to some embodiments.

(85) Operations of electronic device **1700** will now be discussed with reference to the flow chart of FIG. **19** according to some embodiments of inventive concepts. For example, modules (also referred to as units) may be stored in memory **1705** of FIG. **17**, and these modules may provide instructions so that when the instructions of a module are executed by processor **1703**, processor **1703** performs respective operations of the flow chart of FIG. **19**.

(86) At block **1910**, processor **1703** may wait for an encoded bitstream to be provided. At block **1912**, processor **1703** may receive an encoded bitstream. The processor **1703** may receive the encoded bitstream from a remote source over a network through communication interface **1701** and/or by retrieving the encoded bitstream from memory **1705**. According to some embodiments, processor **1703** may first receive the encoded bitstream and then save the encoded video sequence to memory **1705** for later retrieval from memory. The encoded bitstream may comprise parameter set information comprising a syntax indicator or a syntax element that is indicative of at least two values. The encoded bitstream can further comprise a first coded portion comprising first coded sample information for a picture, and a second coded portion comprising second coded sample information for the picture.

(87) In some embodiments, the parameter set information precedes the picture header in the encoded bitstream. The picture header may precede the first coded portion in the encoded bitstream and the first coded portion may precede the second coded portion in the encoded bitstream.

(88) In some embodiments, the first coded portion comprises a first video coding layer (“VCL”) network abstraction layer (“NAL”) unit and the second coded portion comprises a second VCL NAL unit. In additional or alternative embodiments, the parameter set information is comprised in a sequence parameter set. In some embodiments, the syntax indicator is indicative of one of multiple values. In additional or alternative embodiments, the syntax indicator comprises a flag.

(89) At block **1920**, processor **1703** may detect a value of a syntax indicator in the encoded bitstream. Responsive to detecting a first value of the syntax indicator the processor **1703** may perform operations at block **1930**.

(90) At block **1930**, processor **1703** may determine if a picture header is missing from the encoded bitstream. In response to detecting that the picture header is missing the processor **1703** may perform operations at block **1932**.

(91) At block **1932**, processor **1703** can perform error handling. In some embodiments, processor **1703** can determine an error occurred based on the absence of the picture header. The processor **1703** may report the error over a communication network to a source of the encoded bitstream. The processor **1703** may perform error concealment for a decoded bitstream generated based on decoding the first coded sample information and the second coded sample information.

(92) At block **1934**, processor **1703** may decode the encoded bitstream using picture header syntax element **1934**. In some embodiments, the first coded portion comprises first header information with a first coded portion syntax element and the second coded portion comprises second header information with a second coded portion syntax element. Decoding the first coded sample information may comprise decoding the first coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the picture header and using the first coded portion syntax element. Decoding the second coded sample information may comprise decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the picture header and using the second coded portion syntax element.

(93) At block **1936**, processor **1703** may generate a decoded bitstream from the encoded bitstream. In some embodiments, processor **1703** may generate the decoded bitstream based on decoding the first coded sample information and based on decoding the second coded sample information. At block **1938**, processor **1703** may render an image on a display (e.g., screen **1709**) based on the decoded bitstream.

(94) At block **1940**, processor **1703** may determine whether the decoding of the encoded bitstream is completed. If the decoding of the encoded bitstream is not completed, processor **1703** may return to block **1930** to further decode the encoded bitstream. In some embodiments, the encoded bitstream is an encoded video bitstream. The picture is a first picture, the picture header is a first picture header, the picture header syntax elements is a first picture header syntax element. The encoded bitstream can further comprise a third coded portion comprising third coded sample information for a second picture and a fourth coded portion comprising fourth coded sample information for the second picture. In some embodiments, the second coded portion precedes the second picture header in the encoded bitstream and the second picture header precedes each of the third and fourth coded portions in the coded bitstream. In some embodiments, the first picture header syntax element can comprise first syntax information and the second picture header syntax element can comprise second syntax information different than the first syntax information. In some embodiments, processor **1703** may detect that an error has occurred based on failure to detect a second picture header associated with the second picture. During subsequent operations at blocks **1930**, **1932**, **1934**, **1936**, and **1938** the processor **1703** may decode the third and fourth coded portions and render the second picture.

(95) If, at block **1940**, the processor **1703** determines that the encoded bitstream has been decoded, the processor **1703** may return to block **1910** and wait for subsequent encoded bitstreams. In some embodiments, the encoded bitstream is a first encoded bitstream, the parameter set information is first parameter set information, the syntax indicator is a first syntax indicator, and the picture is a first picture. A second encoded bitstream can be received by processor **1703**. The second encoded bitstream can comprise second parameter set information comprising a second syntax indicator having a second value different than the first value, a third coded portion comprising third coded sample information for a second picture, a fourth coded portion comprising fourth coded sample information for the second picture. The third coded portion can comprise third header information with a third coded portion syntax element and the fourth coded portion can comprise fourth header information with a fourth coded portion syntax element. Responsive to the second syntax indicator having the second value different than the first value, the processor **1703** can, at block **1954**, decode the third coded sample information using the third coded portion syntax element. The processor **1703** can also, at block **1954**, responsive to the second syntax indicator having the second value different than the first value, decode the fourth coded sample information using the fourth coded portion syntax element.

(96) In some embodiments, the first value of the first syntax indicator indicates the presence of the first picture header for the first picture in the first encoded bitstream, and the second value of the second syntax indicator indicates the absence of a picture header for the second picture in the second encoded bitstream.

(97) In additional or alternative embodiments, wherein the first value of the first syntax indicator indicates the presence of picture headers for all pictures in the first encoded bitstream, and wherein the second value of the second syntax indicator indicates the absence of a picture header for all pictures in the second encoded bitstream.

(98) Responsive to detecting that the syntax indicator is a second value at block **1920**, the processor may perform operations at block **1950**. At block **1950**, processor **1703** determines whether a picture header is detected. In response to detecting that the picture header is present in the encoded bitstream, the processor can perform operations at block **1952**. At block **1952**, processor **1703** can perform similar error handling as described in block **1932**.

- (99) At block **1954**, processor **1703** decodes the encoded bitstream using a syntax element comprised in the coded portion. At block **1956**, processor **1703** may generate a decoded bitstream from the encoded bitstream. At block **1958**, processor **1703** may render an image on a display (e.g., screen **1709**) based on the decoded bitstream.
- (100) At block **1960**, processor **1703** may determine whether the decoding of the encoded bitstream is completed. If the decoding of the encoded bitstream is not completed, processor **1703** may return to block **1950** to further decode the encoded bitstream. Otherwise, the processor **1703** may return to block **1910** and wait for subsequent encoded bitstreams.
- (101) In some embodiments, the encoded bitstream comprises a stream of bits for which the parameter set information is active. The parameter set information being active can comprise using the parameter set information to decode all coded sample information of respective coded portions of the stream of bits comprising the first and second coded portions. The first encoded bitstream can be a first portion of a stream of bits for which the first parameter set information is active and the second encoded bitstream can be a second portion of the stream of bits for which the second parameter set information is active. In additional or alternative embodiments, the first parameter set information being active can comprise using the first parameter set information to decode all coded sample information of respective coded portions of first portion of the stream of bits comprising the first and second coded portions. The second parameter set information being active can comprise using the second parameter set information to decode all coded sample information of respective coded portions of second portion of the stream of bits comprising the third and fourth coded portions.
- (102) Various operations of FIG. **19** may be optional with respect to some embodiments. In some embodiments, operations of blocks **1910**, **1932**, **1936**, **1938**, **1940**, **1950**, **1952**, **1954**, **1956**, **1958**, and **1960** of FIG. **19** may be optional.
- (103) In some embodiments, electronic device **1700** can generate encoded image by generating the encoded bitstream described in FIGS. **18-19**.

Claims

1. A method of processing encoded image data, the method comprising: receiving an encoded bitstream comprising parameter set information including a syntax indicator, a first slice comprising first coded sample information for a first picture, a second slice comprising second coded sample information for the first picture, a third slice comprising third coded sample information for a second picture and a fourth slice comprising fourth coded sample information for the second picture; responsive to detecting a first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element from a first picture header of the encoded `[.video.]` bitstream; and responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator, decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header of the encoded `[.video.]` bitstream, responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator. `.Iadd., .Iaddend.` detecting that `[.as.]`. `.Iadd.an .Iaddend.` error has occurred based on failure `[.on detecting.]`. `.Iadd.to detect .Iaddend.` a second picture header associated with the second picture, wherein `[.the.]`. `.Iadd.each of said first picture header and said second .Iaddend.` picture header is a `[.NAL.]`. `.Iadd.Network Abstraction Layer (NAL) .Iaddend.` unit having a specific NAL unit type that indicates that the NAL unit contains picture header syntax elements.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the parameter set information precedes the `.Iadd.first .Iaddend.` picture header in the encoded `[.video.]` bitstream, wherein the first picture header precedes the first slice in the encoded `[.video.]` bitstream, and wherein the first slice precedes the second slice in the encoded `[.video.]` bitstream.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the first slice comprises first header information with a first `.Iadd.slice .Iaddend.` syntax element, wherein the second slice comprises second header information

with a second slice syntax element, wherein decoding the first coded sample information comprises decoding the first coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header and using the first slice syntax element, and wherein decoding the second coded sample information comprises decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header **[.16.]** and using the second slice syntax element.

[.4. A computer program comprising program code to be executed by at least one processor of an electronic device, wherein execution of the program code causes the electronic device to perform a method according to claim 1..**].**

5. An electronic device comprising: processing circuitry; and memory coupled with the processing circuitry, wherein the memory includes instructions that when executed by the processing circuitry causes the electronic device to: receive an encoded bitstream comprising parameter set information including a syntax indicator, a first slice comprising first coded sample information for a first picture, a second slice comprising second coded sample information for the first picture, a third slice comprising third coded sample information for a second picture and a fourth slice comprising fourth coded sample information for the second picture; responsive to detecting a first value of the syntax indicator, decode the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element from a first picture header of the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream; and responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator, decode the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header of the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream, responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator, detect that **[.as.]** **.Iadd.an** **.Iaddend.error** has occurred based on failure **[.on detecting.]** **.Iadd.to detect** **.Iaddend.a** second picture header associated with the second picture, wherein **[.the.]** **.Iadd.each** of said first picture header and said second **.Iaddend.picture** header is a **[.NAL.]** **.Iadd.Network Abstraction Layer (NAL)** **.Iaddend.unit** having a specific NAL unit type that indicates that the NAL unit contains picture header syntax elements.

6. The device of claim 5, wherein the parameter set information precedes the **.Iadd.first** **.Iaddend.picture** header in the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream, wherein the first picture header precedes the first slice in the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream, and wherein the first slice precedes the second slice in the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream.

7. The device of claim 5, wherein the first slice comprises first header information with a first **.Iadd.slice** **.Iaddend.syntax** element, wherein the second slice comprises second header information with a second slice syntax element, wherein decoding the first coded sample information comprises decoding the first coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header and using the first slice syntax element, and wherein decoding the second coded sample information comprises decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header **[.16.]** and using the second slice syntax element.

8. A computer program product comprising a non-transitory storage medium comprising program code to be executed by at least one processor of an electronic device, wherein execution of the program code causes the electronic device to: receive an encoded bitstream comprising parameter set information including a syntax indicator, a first slice comprising first coded sample information for a first picture, a second slice comprising second coded sample information for the first picture, a third slice comprising third coded sample information for a second picture and a fourth slice comprising fourth coded sample information for the second picture; responsive to detecting a first value of the syntax indicator, decode the first coded sample information using a picture header syntax element from a first picture header of the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream; and responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator, decode the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header of the encoded **[.video.]** bitstream, responsive to detecting the first value of the syntax indicator, detect that **[.as.]** **.Iadd.an**

.Iaddend.error has occurred based on failure .[.on detecting.]. .Iadd.to detect .Iaddend.a second picture header associated with the second picture, wherein .[.the.]. .Iadd.each of said first picture header and said second .Iaddend.picture header is a .[.NAL.]. .Iadd.Network Abstraction Layer (NAL) .Iaddend.unit having a specific NAL unit type that indicates that the NAL unit contains picture header syntax elements.

9. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein the parameter set information precedes the .Iadd.first .Iaddend.picture header in the encoded .[.video.]. bitstream, wherein the first picture header precedes the first slice in the encoded .[.video.]. bitstream, and wherein the first slice precedes the second slice in the encoded .[.video.]. bitstream.

10. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein the first slice comprises first header information with a first .Iadd.slice .Iaddend.syntax element, wherein the second slice comprises second header information with a second slice syntax element, wherein decoding the first coded sample information comprises decoding the first coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header and using the first slice syntax element, and wherein decoding the second coded sample information comprises decoding the second coded sample information using the picture header syntax element from the first picture header .[.16.]. and using the second slice syntax element.
